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The Des Moines Register Sports
THURSDAY, JANUARY 26, 1956. ★★★★★ 9

Comic Dictionary
YOUNGSTER — A little child to whom all troubles are big.
(Copyright, 1956.)

GREENBERG, CRONIN IN HALL OF FAME

Sittin' ★ In ★
With the Athletes
—BY SEC TAYLOR—

QUICK RISE TO MAJORS.

HE WAS signed by the Boston Braves after he had a college record of only one victory and six defeats.

He had received offers from several big league clubs before that.

CONLEY.

He had been offered a pro basketball contract before any baseball scouts were interested in him.

He jumped from one season in a Class A league to the Braves, but had to go back to the triple-A American Association twice.

He played pro basketball in the winter months.

He was given a large amount of money by the Milwaukee Braves "not to play basketball."

He was credited with the National League's All-Star game victory in 1955, but was charged with its defeat in '54.

He had no curve ball in college and it was a basketball coach and not his baseball coach who showed him how to throw one.

He is Gene Conley, 25-year-old, 227-pound, 6-foot-8 pitcher, who has been here taking treatments for his arm from Dr. M. D. Cramer.

—

HE WAS AN excellent high school baseball and basketball player, much sought after by college coaches. Eventually he matriculated at Washington State.

There he was successful at the indoor game, making the all-Pacific Coast Conference team the only year he competed there, but his baseball pitching left a lot to be desired.

"I just couldn't throw a curve," he explained. "One day Jack Friel, the basketball coach, asked me how I held the ball for a curve. I was gripping it on the seams. He told me to try holding it on the smooth part of the ball.

"I experimented and sure enough, I not only could throw the curve, but I could control it."

—

THAT summer Conley, who had earlier been chosen as the state of Washington representative in the Hearst all-America boys' game in New York, played baseball with a Walla Walla, Wash., semipro club, and perfected his curve.

He competed with and against several former pro players at Walla Walla. The team was watched by major league scouts. They, with those who had seen him in the game in New York, began dickering with him.

"Is the story true that your college baseball coach yanked you from some games when he learned that big league scouts were there and that is the reason you were unable to finish more games?" I asked.

"That's about 40 per cent true, but the big reason was that I couldn't throw curves and couldn't control the ball when I tried to throw them."

—

CONLEY went on to explain that he had three objectives as a youngster—to pitch in the major leagues, to play basketball in Madison Square Garden and to play in the Rose Bowl.

"But I didn't play football so I never got in the Rose Bowl. However, I've played ball in every National League park, plus the Cleveland Municipal Stadium, and I've played basketball in the Gar-

SITTIN' IN—
Continued on Page Ten.

WEST VIRGINIA RULES AGAINST MIXED MATCH

PARKERSBURG, W. VA. (AP)—The West Virginia State Athletic Commission will have no part of a wrestling match in which "the Blimp" might do violence to "Lady Angel" or "the Golden Venus."

Promoter W. H. Stephens had planned a mixed match teaming one of the above mentioned women either with The Blimp or Mr. America.

But the commission Wednesday spiked the promotion, stating that the match "does not conform to the type of program the commission is interested in seeing carried on."

In a more chivalrous affair, The Blimp will face Mr. America and the women will struggle with each other tonight.

North Rolls, 70-52, Ties for Top

HALL, JUBER PUSH TECH'S LOSSES TO 14

Bears, Riders Share Lead at 4-1.

CITY SERIES STANDINGS.

	W.	L.	Pct.
North	4	1	.800
Roosevelt	4	1	.800
East	[illegible]	1	[illegible]
Lincoln	[illegible]	4	[illegible]
Tech	0	5	.000

By Bill McGrane.

North, running hot and cold all the way, thumped Tech, 70-52, Wednesday night at East to move into a tie with Roosevelt for the City Series lead.

North and the Riders have 4-1 records.

Hall 14, Juber 10.

Lanky centers Jim Hall and Paul Juber provided the scoring punch and rebounding power which sent Tech to its fourteenth consecutive loss.

PICTURE: Page 10.

Hall, 6 feet 6 inches, rattled in 14 points, and Juber, 6-4, hit 10.

Hall and forward Dave Miller collected 11 points for North in the first quarter, with North leading at the buzzer, 17-11.

The Bears hit their best stride of the night in the second quarter for 24 points.

Bob Fong, 5-5 reserve forward, sparked that outburst with four baskets.

Hall and Juber, aided by the exceptional feeding of guard Tom Moore, also scored easily and the Bears moved to a 41-26 halftime lead.

12 Free Throws.

North Coach Jimmy Lyle cleared his bench in the second half.

Dennis Cooper, 5-9 Tech guard, had a field day from the foul line, scoring on 12 out of 14 free throw attempts. He led all scorers with 18 points.

North's reserves took the opening game, 53-39.

North—70	FG.	FT.	F.
Miller,f	1	3-5	1
Burnett,f	0	0-0	1
J.Hall,c	6	2-3	3
Moore,g	3	0-0	1
[illegible],g	3	0-0	1
Juber,c-f	5	0-1	4
Fong,g	4	0-1	3
Long,f	3	0-0	2
Davenport,f	1	0-0	0
Green,g	1	2-2	0
Mott,f	0	2-2	1
[illegible],f	1	0-0	1
T.Hall,f	1	[illegible]	2
Newell,g	0	0-0	1
Scott,f	0	0-0	0
Owens,f	0	0-0	0
Totals	29	12-18	21

Tech—52	FG.	FT.	F.
Norris,f	3	3-4	3
Jorgenson,f	0	4-4	2
Gulick,c	3	0-3	2
[illegible],g	3	0-1	1
Dingman,f	3	3-5	1
Morris,f	0	0-1	1
Cooper,g	3	12-14	1
[illegible],g	0	0-1	1
Sheurer,g	0	0-1	0
Hill,g	0	0-0	0
Totals	15	22-34	12

Score by quarters:

North	17	24	14	15	—70
Tech	11	15	12	14	—52

Sports Today

Basketball.

DES MOINES—Bradley at Drake, 8:15 p. m., with preliminary between Palmer vs. Drake freshmen at 6:15 p. m.

STATE—Carthage at Penn.

Swimming.

DES MOINES—Boone at Lincoln.

Looking for Champions in 1956

Bill Bruton (left), Milwaukee Braves outfielder, and Bucky O'Connor, coach of the State University of Iowa basketball team, said Wednesday night at the Sports of Sorts Club meeting here that their teams could win championships this year. The Braves finished second in the National League last season. O'Connor's Hawkeyes currently are second in the Big Ten race.

* * *

GIAMBRA GOES PAST ANDREWS

NORFOLK, VA. (AP)—Slow-starting middleweight Joey Giambra punched out a unanimous 10-round decision over Al Andrews Wednesday night. Giambra weighed 158 pounds and Andrews 161¾.

Giambra, an aspirant for the world middleweight title recently discharged from the army, was making his first ring appearance since losing to Bobo Olson last August.

Andrews, who fought a losing decision to Joey Giardello in this ring last year, was the aggressor in the early going but Giambra finished strong.

There were no knockdowns but twice Giambra opened cuts over the eyes of Andrews, a 2-1 underdog.

The victory was the forty-second in 47 fights for Giambra. Andrews' record includes 43 victories, 15 defeats and two draws.

Giambra was set for a title crack at Olson until Bobo lost his crown Dec. 9 to Sugar Ray Robinson.

O'Connor, Bruton Believe Hawks, Braves Can Win

By Bill Bryson.

Bucky O'Connor and Bill Bruton showed no lack of confidence in their respective championship possibilities Wednesday night under the grilling of Sports of Sorts Club members here.

O'Connor, coach of Iowa's defending Big Ten basketball champions, admitted that undefeated Illinois is "in very good position, but we're up there now with a chance to catch 'em."

Bucky said that, although the Big Ten apparently has "settled down to a two or three team race, there are at least five teams who can possibly upset the leaders."

Bruton, the high-velocity center fielder of the Milwaukee Braves, said he "sees no reason why we can't beat out the Dodgers if our pitching comes through."

'Best Pitching.'

"Potentially we had the best pitching in the majors last season," he said, "but they didn't come through. I think they will this year."

Bill said Milwaukee's greatest need is "a slugger to hit behind Eddie Matthews," the club's home run specialist.

Bruton's response to one question was that "in my opinion Ernie Banks (Cub shortstop) should have been named the most valuable player."

Bill also said he'd like to see Iowa's Jack Dittmer "with a club where he could play every day. He's a great competitor, a good fielder and a tough hitter with men on base."

At Milwaukee the past two years, Dittmer has been superseded at second base by Danny O'Connell.

"It was my own idea and of the 65 men in attendance should remind Bruton how unpopular he was here one night in 1951 when he bunted a no-hit game away from the Bruins' Paul Menking.

Own Idea.

It was only natural that one not ordered by Manager Andy Cohen," said Bill, who played for Denver that season.

"If it had been a one-sided game, I wouldn't have bunted, but it was 1-0 or 2-0, so we still had a good chance. I figured it was my job to get on base and start a rally.

"I was up first in the ninth and I bunted Menking's first pitch, but it went foul. Your third baseman (Vern Morgan) already was in on me and he moved in a couple more steps.

"I bunted the next one toward him and thought sure I'd be out. It wasn't a very good bunt. I don't know what happened, but it took that ball a long time to get to first and I beat it out."

JACOBS AGREES.

KANSAS CITY, MO. (AP)—The Athletics said Wednesday that infielder Spook Jacobs had signed his 1956 contract.

SOME FALLS, BUT IT'S ONLY A TEASER—

Haul Snow for Winter Games' Start

CORTINA D'AMPEZZO, ITALY (AP)—A light snow, the first in 15 days, fell on the starved slopes of this Alpine village Wednesday but it was only a tease on the eve of the seventh Winter Olympic games.

While officials and competitors watched hopefully, snow drifted down for about half an hour. Then it stopped, before it could even begin to cover bare courses. Then the clouds began blowing away.

Little Snow.

So this giant international spectacle of snow and ice, an $8,000,000 undertaking harrassed by the snow drought and racked by injuries, opens formally today with skiing conditions still hazardous. No more snow is in sight.

The situation was so desperate that snow was being trucked in from the mountains and spread in the center of the village for today's opening ceremonies.

Still another headache for officials appeared when ice hockey referees threatened to stage a walkout unless they were given better living quarters and compensated for expenses.

The 15 referees, representing each of the 10 countries in the tournament, held an

OLYMPICS—
Continued on Page Ten.

* * *

MARCHING ORDERS.

CORTINA D'AMPEZZO, ITALY (AP) — American Winter Olympic athletes got their marching orders Wednesday night—no cameras, and keep in formation during the big opening day parade today.

Kenneth L. (Tug) Wilson of Chicago, president of the U. S. Olympic group, told the U. S. squad:

"We don't want a repetition of what we had in London in 1948 when some U. S. representatives broke ranks to take pictures of the king."

BRADLEY SENDS TWO 6-7 SOPHS AGAINST DRAKE

Bulldogs Seek 7th Victory Tonight.

PROBABLE LINEUPS.

DRAKE.		BRADLEY.
Hutchins, 6-2	F	Gower, 6-4
Murrell, 6-4	F	Emerson, 6-7
Cerf, 6-6	C	Cable, 6-7
Olmsted, 6-4 or Carey, 6-0	G	Johnson, 6-0
Gaer, 6-0, or Funk, 6-2	G	Sedgwick, 6-1

Time and place—8:15 p. m. Drake Fieldhouse.

Average height of starters—Drake 6-3 1/5; Bradley 6-3 4/5.

Broadcasts—KSO, KWDM, WHO-FM, Des Moines, with rebroadcast by WHO at 10:30 p. m.; WEEK, WIRL, Peoria, Ill.

Drake plays the first of two strong opponents this weekend when it goes against Bradley tonight at the Fieldhouse here. The Bulldogs engage Detroit here Saturday night.

Game time is 8:15 o'clock, with the Drake freshmen meeting the Palmer School of Davenport in a 6:15 preliminary.

Improving Bradley will bring a 9-5 record and tall players to face Coach Jack McClelland's Bulldogs. In the rough-tough Missouri Valley Conference race, the Brave have split in four games.

Their two victories were over Wichita and Detroit, which manhandled the Bulldogs.

Coach Bob Vanatta of Bradley will have two 6-7 performers in his lineup, sophomores Barney Cable, who works at center and forward, and forward Dave Emerson. Vanatta frequently uses a double post offensive system, sending 6-9 Gene Herberger into action.

McClelland is undecided about his starting guards. He might start his "newcomer" duo of Kent Gaer and Jim Carey, or stick with his veterans, Terry Olmsted and George Funk.

The Bulldogs will be out to snap a four-game losing streak. Drake has a 6-7 season mark.

GIARDELLO GETS LICENSE AGAIN

PHILADELPHIA, PENN. (AP)—Middleweight Joey Giardello was given back his license Wednesday by the Pennsylvania State Athletic Commission.

GIARDELLO.

Giardello, 25, recently released from prison after serving part of a term for assault and battery during a row at a south Philadelphia gasoline station, was given a clean bill of health by the commission.

Mayor Richardson Dilworth of Philadelphia; former district Attorney Samuel Dash; Judge Edward P. Little, who sentenced the fighter to prison, and Walter E. Lorman, jr., chief probation officer, urged the commission to give Giardello a license.

Giardello has signed a contract with Francis DeVicaris of Philadelphia, also known by his former ring name of Frankie Caris, as his manager.

Giardello once was the No. 1 middleweight contender. He now ranks seventh.

Giardello hasn't fought since March, 1955.

Hitting Greats Easily 'Beat' Ruffing, Roush

NEW YORK, N. Y. (AP)—Hank Greenberg and Joe Cronin, two of the best right-handed hitters of the modern age, Wednesday were elected to the Baseball Hall of Fame at Cooperstown, N. Y., by the 10-year members of the Baseball Writers Association.

Hank Greenberg.
Ninth-Best in Homers.

Joe Cronin.
Lifetime Average: .302.

Greenberg is general manager of the Cleveland Indians and Cronin is general manager of the Boston Red Sox, both in the American League where they spent most of their brilliant major league careers.

A total of 193 ballots were received from the eligible writers, with Greenberg earning 164 votes and Cronin 152.

Three-fourths of those cast, 145, was necessary for election. Only players active in the 1930-50 period were eligible for recognition and they could not be active as a coach or manager within the last five years.

Cronin and Greenberg were the only players close to election.

97 Choose Ruffing.

Red Ruffing, New York Yankee pitcher, was third with 97 votes. Then came Ed Roush, former Cincinnati outfielder, with 91.

Others among the first 10 were Lefty Gomez, 89, Hack Wilson 74, Tony Lazzeri 64, Kiki Cuyler 55, Hank Gowdy 49 and Sam Rice 45.

"In all my years of being on the playing field I never dreamed that this would be the final result," Greenberg said. "I can't possibly express how I feel. It's just too wonderful for words.

"I'm deeply grateful and humble for this great honor the writers saw fit to bestow upon me.

"I guess that is what every ball player dreams about but never hopes to achieve.

"I'm also glad that Joe Cronin was named, too. He was one of the greatest ball players and toughest competitors I ever saw."

HALL OF FAME VOTING.

The leading players in Baseball Hall of Fame election; 145 of 193 ballots necessary for election:

Hank Greenberg	164
Joe Cronin	152
Charlie Ruffing	97
Ed Roush	91
Vernon Gomez	89
Hack Wilson	74
aMax Carey	65
Tony Lazzeri	64
Kiki Cuyler	55
Hank Gowdy	49
Sam Rice	45
Chuck Klein	44
Jim Bottomley	42
Waite Hoyt	37
Urban Faber	34
Joe Medwick	31
Eppa Rixey	[illegible]
aZach Wheat	26
Leon (Goose) Goslin	26
Burleigh Grimes	25

a—Not eligible since career ended before 1930.

Had 331 Homers.

Greenberg, now 45, had a lifetime batting average of .313 for 1,394 big league games, most of them with the Detroit Tigers.

The 6-foot 3-inch first baseman-outfielder hit 58 homers for the Tigers in 1938 and is ninth on the list of all-time home run hitters with 331.

Big Hank came up to the majors in 1930 at Detroit and returned to stay in 1933, remaining with the Tigers through 1946 with the exception of 1942-44, when he was in service.

He was sold to Pittsburgh, Jan. 18, 1947, and finished his playing career with the Pirates. At the end of the '47 season he was released at his own request to become a part owner at Cleveland.

A New York boy, Greenberg appeared in four World Series with Detroit and played in two All-Star games. He collected 1,628 hits.

At Newton, Mass., Cronin called his election the "greatest thrill of my career."

"I'm just as happy as a person can be," Cronin said.

"Just knowing I was being considered was a great honor. It's even greater to be in there with such fellows as Babe Ruth, Lou Gehrig, Bill Dickey, Mickey Cochrane, Gabby Hartnett and all the others.

"It's also a great honor to go in with another great ball player—Hank Green-

HALL—
Continued on Page Eleven.

Cubs Show First Profit Since '52

CHICAGO, ILL. (AP) — The Chicago Cub organization showed a $60,000 profit for 1955, its first in-the-black season since 1952.

This was revealed Wednesday at the club stockholders' meeting at which the club board of directors and all officers were re-elected.

P. K. Wrigley was re-elected president; Clarence (Pants) Rowland, executive vice-president; Margaret Donahue, vice-president and secretary, and William J. Hagenah, jr., treasurer.

James T. Gallagher was re-appointed business manager.

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SPORTS MEMORIES
by Dave Fidler
"Hurry Up" Yost's teams at Michigan, known as the "point a minute" teams in the years of 1901-02-03-04 and 05, won 55 games, lost one and tied one. They scored 2821 points to opponents' 42.
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